Guide for authors - Information and Software Technology (Elsevier). URL:

sciencedirec

Guide for authors - Information and Software Technology - ISSN 0950-5849 | ScienceDirect.com by

Elsevier

- Aims and scope

- Article type

Ethics and policies

- Publishing ethics

- Submissior

Writing and formatting

- File format

- LaTeX

Submitting your manuscript

- Submission checklist

- Submit onl

After receiving a final decision

- Article Transfer Service

- Publishing

Resources for authors

- Elsevier Researcher Academy

- Language a

Getting help and support

- Author support

Aims and scope

Information and Software Technology is the international archival journal focusing on research and

experience t

The journal encourages and welcomes submissions of systematic literature studies (reviews and maps)

within the sc

Article types

Research Papers, Short Communications and Review Articles. We also actively encourage the

submission

A research paper's maximum length is 15,000 words, except for a systematic literature review or

systematic r

Structured Abstract: Papers will not be handled without a structured abstract. The abstract must be

structured h

Special issue proposals

Visit the journal's proposal guidelines to submit a proposal for a special issue (original

contribution

Peer review

This journal follows a single anonymized review process. Your submission will initially be assessed

by our edito

Our editors are not involved in making decisions about papers that:

- they have written themselves.

- have been

Any such submissions will be subject to the journal's usual procedures. Peer review will be handled

independent

Authors may formally appeal the editorial decision, provided the appeal meets all the requirements

and follows

Special issues and article collections

Special issues and article collections follow the same peer review process as regular submissions,

except that a

Open access

See our open access information page to learn about open access options for this journal.

Publishing ethics

Authors must follow ethical guidelines stated in Elsevier's publishing ethics policies.

Submission declaration

When authors submit an article to an Elsevier journal it is implied that:

- The work described has not been published previously except in the form of a preprint, abstract,

published le

To verify compliance with our journal publishing policies, we may check your manuscript with our

screening to

Authorship

All authors should have made substantial contributions to all of the following:

1. The conception and design of the study, or acquisition of data, or analysis and interpretation

of data.

All authors are accountable for all aspects of the work, to ensure that questions related to the accuracy or

Corresponding author

Authors must appoint a single corresponding author to communicate with the journal during the editorial pro

Only the corresponding author's affiliation will be used to determine eligibility for a publishing agreement a

Group authorship

Group authorship refers to the attribution of an article to a defined and named group of authors whose mem

- Group authorship must be declared on the title page at submission. When available, the submitting author shou

Changes to authorship

The editors of this journal generally will not consider changes to authorship once a manuscript has been submit

- All authors must be listed in the manuscript and their details entered into the submission system. Cha

Declaration of competing interests

All authors must disclose any financial and personal relationships with other people or organization

- Employment

- Consultanc

The declarations tool should always be completed.

Authors with a journal affiliation to declare should enter the following text under "Other Activities" wi

Given their role as [AUTHOR JOURNAL ROLE TITLE], [AUTHOR NAME] had no involvement in the peer review of thi

Editorial disclosure statements will be included as a footnote and/or in the declaration of competing i

Authors with no competing interests to declare should select the option "I have nothing to declare."

The resulting Word document containing your declaration should be uploaded at the "attach/upload files" step in

Funding sources

Authors must disclose any funding sources that provided financial support for the conduct of the research and

List funding sources in this standard way to facilitate compliance with funder's requirements:

Funding: This work was supported by the National Institutes of Health [grant numbers xxxx, yyyy]; the Bill & Me

It is not necessary to include detailed descriptions of the program or type of grants, scholarships and awards.

If no funding has been provided for the research, please include the following sentence:

This research did not receive any specific grant from funding agencies in the public, commercial, or not-for-pr

Declaration of generative AI use

Authors must declare the use of generative AI tools in the manuscript preparation process upon submission

Generative AI (GenAI) and AI-assisted technologies (AI tools) have been rapidly adopted in research and scholarl

Authors preparing a manuscript for this journal may use AI tools to support them. However, these tools must n

Please read Elsevier's detailed author policy on the use of AI tools, as stated in Elsevier's GenAI policies for j

Ultimately, authors are responsible and accountable for the contents of their work. This includes accountabili

- Carefully reviewing and verifying the accuracy, comprehensiveness, and impartiality of all AI generated o

Finally, authors must not list or cite AI tools as an author or co-author on the manuscript since authorship i

The use of AI tools in the manuscript preparation process must be declared by adding a statement at the end of th

Title of new section: Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the manuscript preparation

The declaration does not apply to the use of basic tools, such as tools used to check grammar, spelling, and

If you have nothing to disclose, you do not need to add a statement.

Please note: to protect authors' rights and the confidentiality of their research, this journal does not cur

Preprint sharing

Authors may share preprints in line with Elsevier's article sharing policy. Sharing preprints, such as on a prep

We advise you to read our policy on multiple, redundant, or concurrent publication.

In support of Open Science, this journal offers its authors a free preprint posting service on SSRN, Elsevi

During submission to this journal, you can choose to post your manuscript on SSRN, and it will be made public

As a preprint on SSRN, your manuscript will benefit from:

- Early registration with a preprint DOI (Digital Object Identifier)
- A link from

Your decision to post or not post your preprint will have no effect on the editorial process or publication

The corresponding author must seek approval from all co-authors before agreeing to post the manuscript

Use of inclusive language

Inclusive language acknowledges diversity, conveys respect to all people, is sensitive to differences,

- age
- gender

Avoid the use of descriptors about personal attributes unless they are relevant and valid. Write for gender n

Don't make assumptions about the beliefs of readers and keep writing free from bias, stereotypes, slang, refere

These guidelines are meant as a point of reference to help you identify appropriate language but are by no m

Reporting sex- and gender-based analyses

There is no single, universally agreed-upon set of guidelines for defining sex and gender. We offer the followin

- Sex- and gender-based analyses (SGBA) should be integrated into research design when research involves or p

We advise you to read the Sex and Gender Equity in Research (SAGER) guidelines and the SAGER checklist (PD

For further information we suggest reading the rationale behind and recommended use of the SAGER guidelines.

Definitions of sex and/or gender

We ask authors to define how sex and gender have been used in their research and publication. Some guidance:

- Sex generally refers to a set of biological attributes that are associated with physical and physiologica

Depending on the focus of a paper, sex and/or gender may or may not be relevant to the content of

the paper. W

Image manipulation

We accept that authors sometimes need to adjust images for clarity, but any manipulation of images

for the purp

Authors must adhere to this journal's policy for graphical images:

- No specific feature within an image may be enhanced, obscured, moved, removed, or introduced.

- Adjustmen

To verify compliance with the above, this journal may send your images to a secure third-party tool

to enable sc

Authors are encouraged to carefully check all images before submission and to connect all the data

in any figure

Jurisdictional claims

Elsevier respects its authors' decisions on how they choose to designate territories and identify

their affiliati

- Maps: Readers should be able to locate any study areas shown within maps using common mapping

platforms. M

Delayed publication

If you need to delay the publication of your article for any reason, please contact the editorial

office of the

Withdrawal, correction, or retraction

For questions about article withdrawal, correction, or retraction, please consult Elsevier's

Article Corre

File format

Submit your manuscript and additional text-based files in an editable format:

- Submit files with .doc/.docx extensions for Word and .tex for LaTeX files. A PDF is not an

acceptable s

LaTeX

We encourage you use our LaTeX template when preparing a LaTeX submission. You will be asked to

provide all r

Support for your LaTeX submission:

- LaTeX submission instructions and templates

- Journal Art

You are required to include the following details on the title page:

- Article title. Article titles should be concise and informative. Please avoid abbreviations and

formulae, w

Structured abstract

You are required to provide a concise and factual abstract that does not exceed 300 words. The abstract sho

- State the purpose of your paper.

- Outline bas

Some guidelines:

- Abstracts must be able to stand alone, as abstracts are often presented separately from the article.

You are required to provide 1 to 7 keywords for indexing purposes. Keywords should be written in English. Try

Only use abbreviations in keywords if they are firmly established in the field.

You are encouraged to provide article highlights at submission.

Highlights are a short collection of bullet points that should capture the novel results of your research as

- Submit highlights as a separate editable file in the online submission system with the word "highlights"

We encourage you to view example article highlights and read about the benefits of their inclusion.

Graphical abstract

You are encouraged to provide a graphical abstract at submission.

The graphical abstract summarizes the contents of your article in a concise, pictorial, professional

- Ensure you have obtained the necessary permission to include any third-party-owned material in a graphical ab

More information, examples, and a template can be found in the graphical abstract guidelines.

Math formulae

- Submit math equations as editable text, not as images.

- Present sin

Tables

Tables must be submitted as editable text, not as images. Some guidelines:

- Place tables next to the relevant text or on separate page(s) at the end of your article.

- Cite all tabl

Use tables sparingly, ensuring that any data presented in tables is not duplicating results described el

Figures, images, and other artwork

Figures, images, diagrams, and other graphical media (artwork) must be supplied as separate files along with th

When submitting artwork:

- Cite all images in the manuscript text.

- Number im

Captions

All artwork must have a caption. A caption should consist of a brief title (not displayed on the figure itself)

More information about adding captions to your submission..

Formats

Submit your artwork in the formats listed below, following the given requirements:

| Image type | Recommended file type | Requirements |

| --- | --- | ---

Do not submit:

- Files that are too low in resolution.

- Artwork wh

Color artwork

If you submit usable color figures with your accepted article, we will ensure that they appear in color online.

Generative AI and figures, images and other artwork

Please read our policy on the use of generative AI and AI-assisted tools in figures, images, and artwork, wh

- AI tools may be used to support the creation of explanatory images (such as flow charts, conceptual d

Authors are responsible for ensuring the accuracy and originality of all images submitted for publication.

Supplementary material

We encourage the use of supplementary materials such as applications, images, and sound clips to enhance res

- Supplementary material should be accurate and relevant to the research.

- Cite all sup

Video

This journal accepts video material and animation sequences to support and enhance your scientific

research. W

- When including video or animation file links within your article, refer to the video or animation

content by a

We publish all video and animation files supplied in the electronic version of your article.

For more detailed instructions, we recommend that you read our guidelines on submitting video

content to b

Research data

We are committed to supporting the storage of, access to and discovery of research data, and our

research dat

Research data refers to the results of observations or experimentation that validate research

findings, wh

Please read our guidelines on sharing research data for more information on depositing, sharing and

using resear

Research data deposit, citation and linking

For this journal, Option C instructions from our research data guidelines apply. This means that

you are requ

- Deposit your research data in a relevant data repository.

- Cite and lin

Data statement

To foster transparency, you are required to state the availability of any data at submission.

Ensuring data is available may be a requirement of your funding body or institution. If your data

is unavailabl

Read more about the importance and benefits of providing a data statement.

Data linking

Linking to the data underlying your work increases your exposure and may lead to new

collaboratio

If your research data has been made available in a data repository there are a number of ways your

article can b

- Provide a link to your dataset when prompted during the online submission process.

- For some d

Learn more about linking research data and research articles in ScienceDirect.

Co-submission of related data, methods or protocols

You are encouraged to publish a description of your research data, methods, or protocols related to

your regular

This co-submission can be submitted at the same time as your regular manuscript submission to this

journal. If bo

- Prepare a separate manuscript describing your research data, methods, or protocols using the

- MethodsX

Note that due to the automated process of submitting to Data in Brief or MethodsX, you will only be

Please visit the co-submission Researcher Support page for more information on how to submit a

Article sections

- Divide your manuscript into clearly defined and numbered sections. Number subsections 1.1 (then

Acknowledgements

Include any individuals who provided you with help during your research, such as help with

Acknowledgments should be placed in a separate section that appears directly before the reference

Author contributions: CRediT

Corresponding authors are required to acknowledge co-author contributions using CRediT (Contributor

- Conceptualization

Not all CRediT roles will apply to every manuscript, and some authors may contribute through

We advise you to read more about CRediT and view an example of a CRediT author statement.

Appendices

We ask you to use the following format for appendices:

- Identify individual appendices within your article using the format: A, B, etc.

References within text

Any references cited in your article should also be present in your reference list and vice versa.

- References cited in your abstract must be given in full.

Reference format

This journal does not set strict requirements on reference formatting at submission. Some

guidelines:

- References can be in any style or format as long as the style is consistent.

- Author nam

Our journal reference style will be applied to your article after acceptance, at proof stage. If

required, at

Reference style

Indicate references by adding a number within square brackets in the text. You can refer to author

names withi

Number references in the order they appear in your article.

Abbreviate journal names according to the List of Title Word Abbreviations (LTWA).

Reference to a journal publication:

[1] J. van der Geer, T. Handgraaf, R.A. Lupton, The art of writing a scientific article, J. Sci.

Commun. 16

Reference to a journal publication with an article number:

[2] J. van der Geer, T. Handgraaf, R.A. Lupton, 2022. The art of writing a scientific article.

Heliyon. 19,

Reference to a book:

[3] W. Strunk Jr., E.B. White, The Elements of Style, fourth ed., Longman, New York, 2000.

Reference to a chapter in a book:

[4] G.R. Mettam, L.B. Adams, How to prepare an electronic version of your article, in: B.S. Jones,

R.Z. Smith (E

Reference to a website:

[5] Cancer Research UK, Cancer statistics reports for the UK.

http://www.

Reference to a dataset:

[6] M. Oguro, S. Imahiro, S. Saito, T. Nakashizuka, Mortality data for Japanese oak wilt disease

and surroun

Reference to software:

[7] E. Coon, M. Berndt, A. Jan, D. Svyatsky, A. Atchley, E. Kikinzon, D. Harp, G. Manzini, E.

Shelef, K. Lip

Web references

When listing web references, as a minimum you should provide the full URL and the date when the

reference w

You can list web references separately under a new heading directly after your reference list or

include them

Data references

We encourage you to cite underlying or relevant datasets within article text and to list data

references i

When citing data references, you should include:

- author name(s)

- dataset titl

Add [dataset] immediately before your reference. This will help us to properly identify the

dataset. The

Software references

Cite software (including computational code, scripts, models, notebooks, and libraries) in the same

way as other

A reference to software should include the following elements:

- Creator(s): the authors or project that developed the software.
- Title: the na

If an article exists that describes the software, it should be cited as an additional reference
long with th

Preprint references

You may reference preprints that are central to your work or that cover crucial developments in the
topic, but ar

Mark preprints clearly. Include the word "preprint" or the name of the preprint server as part of
your referen

Where a preprint has subsequently become available as a peer-reviewed publication, use the formal
publication a

Reference management software

Most journals have their reference template available in popular reference management software
products. Th

If you use a citation plug-in from these products, select the relevant journal template, and all
your citation

If a template is not available for this journal, follow the format given in examples in the
reference st

Submission checklist

Before completing the submission of your manuscript, we advise you to read our submission checklist:

- One author has been designated as the corresponding author, and their full contact details have
been provid

Submit online

Our online submission system guides you through the process of entering your manuscript details and
uploading y

Follow this link to submit your paper.

All correspondence, including notification of the editor's decision and requests for revision, is
sent by ema

Article Transfer Service

If your manuscript is more suitable for an alternative journal published by Elsevier, you may
receive an e

The recommendation could come from the journal editor, a dedicated in-house scientific managing
editor, a too

If you agree with the recommendation, your manuscript will be transferred and independently
reviewed by

Publishing agreement

Authors are asked to complete a publishing agreement after acceptance. The corresponding author

receives a li

Elsevier's policies related to copyright explain more about our copyright policies, and additional

rights for su

See our open access information page to learn about open access options for this journal.

If excerpts from other copyrighted works are included in your article, you must obtain written

permission f

Proof correction

To ensure a fast publication process, we ask you to provide proof corrections within two days.

Corresponding authors will receive an email with a link to our online proofing system. There you

can edit text

Alt text for images and captions or audio descriptions for videos may have been added to improve

accessibility.

The purpose of the proof is to check the typesetting, editing, completeness, and correctness of

your article

Sharing your published article

To share your article on social media or by email, we send the corresponding author the Digital

Object Ident

Responsible sharing

We encourage you to share and promote your article to give additional visibility to your work,

enabling you

Elsevier Researcher Academy

If you would like help to improve your submission or navigate the publication process, support is

available via

Elsevier Researcher Academy offers free e-learning modules, webinars, downloadable guides, and

research wri

Language and editing services

We recommend that you write in American or British English but not a combination of both.

If you feel your manuscript requires editing to eliminate possible grammar or spelling errors, and

conform to

Author support

We recommend that you visit our Journal Article Publishing Support Center if you have questions

about the ed

- Publishing ethics

- Submissior

- Article Transfer Service

- Publishing